

OUTRIDERS

A FUN LOOTER SHOOTER, ESPECIALLY FOR THE LONE WOLF

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Before we get into the details of Outriders, I must warn you that I am not a fan of the looter shooter genre. While I have enjoyed a few rounds of Destiny and The Division, these games have never immersed me for one single reason – if you don't have friends to play with, the game isn't fun. And that's generally the case with looter shooter games. To my surprise, Outriders is a looter shooter that's a lot of fun when played alone and immense fun when played with friends. The game has a good balance of combat, difficulty and some special abilities to spice up the gameplay.

STORY

Developer, People Can Fly, delivered a great tongue in cheek action flick story in Bulletstorm, but that isn't the case here. While there are moments of levity thrown into the mix, the story of Outriders is relatively serious. The earth is no longer inhabitable, and humanity is looking at the planet

Enoch to rebuild civilisation.

As expected, things don't go according to plan. After a brief tutorial, you find yourself in cryosleep for 31 years. After awakening, you realise that not only are the humans fighting among themselves for resources, but there is a storm that transforms some people into the "Altered", giving them special abilities. Surprise, surprise, you are one of the Altered.

While it is difficult to take the overarching story seriously, the subplots and side missions intrigued me. There is one mission where you must investigate the mishaps in a mine only to find out that an ally is misusing the mine for his benefits. There is also one side mission where soldiers are vanishing and forced into a cult. These subplots are exciting and have the potential to inject some humour into a story that tries to take itself too seriously.

GAMEPLAY

Outriders is a third-person cover-based shooter, but it encourages you

to leave cover from time to time. It is a looter shooter best enjoyed with friends. However, you can enjoy the game alone. The game lets you choose from four classes - The Trickster, who can manipulate time and space; the Pyromancer, who can manipulate fire; the Devastator, who unleashes seismic attacks like an earthquake; and the Technomancer, who uses devices like turrets. I have been playing the game using the Pyromancer class.

On the DualSense controller, a player can equip three abilities at a time - one to each shoulder button, while the third ability is triggered by pressing both the shoulder buttons together. While the game offers cover-based shooting, it encourages you to move around the battlefield and use your powers as often as possible. The cooldown for your capabilities is relatively quick, and you regenerate health when you use your abilities. There are no health packs to be found.

Each level is divided into areas where you take on a hoard of ene-